

GLOBAL SCREENING · SANCTIONS CONTROLS

Stopping sanctioned banks at the point of payment

How our BIN blocking control works, from designation to declined payment



We block sanctioned banks ourselves, inside our own payment flow

We have no direct relationship with the issuing bank



The check runs here
after the issuer BIN is extracted, before anything reaches the scheme

WHAT WE ARE EXPOSED TO

Payments from sanctioned issuers
Real-time, high-volume card traffic from any bank under sanctions

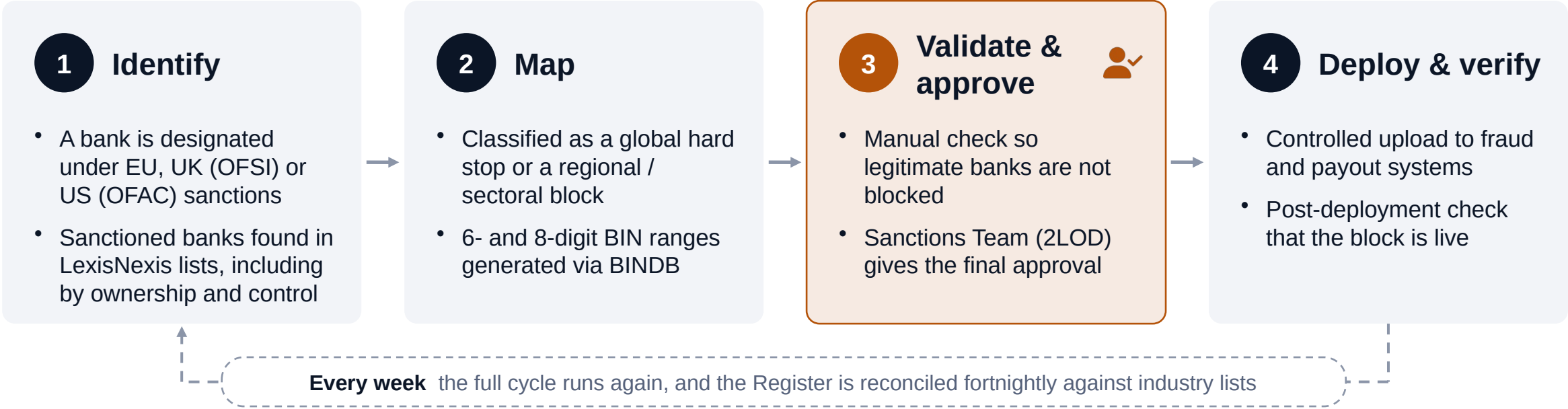
Payouts to sanctioned issuers
Card payouts and refunds that would credit a card issued by a sanctioned bank

Routing we don't control
Acquirers and intermediaries that may sit in sanctioned regions

The block list is updated weekly, with an emergency route for major designations

- 1 The list
- 2 Every payment
- 3 Who owns it

Output: the Sanctioned BIN List, used in Part 2





Emergency route for a major designation

Expedited approval, and a temporary block goes in before full BIN regeneration. Documentation and validation are completed afterwards.

2 hours

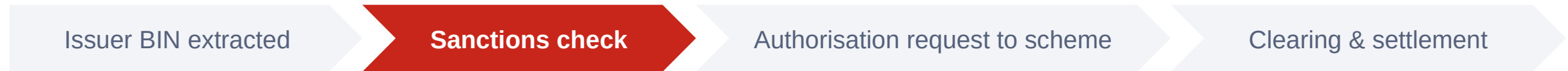
to update the Register after a major designation

Every card payment and payout is checked before it reaches the scheme

1 The list

2 Every payment

3 Who owns it



PAYMENT TYPE

WHAT IS CHECKED, AND WHERE

OUTCOME



On every match a Sanctions_Block_Event is logged and retained, and escalated per Compliance procedures where required

Every step has an owner, and people make the decisions

1 The list

2 Every payment

3 Who owns it

1LOD

Payments & Engineering

Build and run the controls

- Fraud Detection: real-time BIN checks for acquiring
- FinCrime Engineering: payout validation layer, event logging, no bypass
- FinCrime Product: control design, aligned to regulatory requirements

Weekly

The full BIN list update cycle

2LOD

Sanctions Team

Own the list and approve changes

- Owns the Sanctions Hard Block Register
- Sets the global vs regional block taxonomy
- Sole approver for adding or whitelisting BINs, and shared-BIN exceptions

2 hours

To update the Register after a major designation

3LOD

Internal Audit

Independent assurance

- Tests the design and operating effectiveness of real-time BIN blocking

1 hour

To report any payment that did not follow the workflow

Four things that make BIN blocking harder than it looks



Names don't match across datasets

The same bank is written differently in sanctions lists and BIN databases: abbreviations, transliterations, legal forms. Matching on unique identifiers such as the LEI is the long-term fix.



BINs aren't banks

One bank spans many 6- and 8-digit ranges, and some BINs are shared across territories. Too broad and you block legitimate banks; too narrow and you miss one.



Lists move faster than BIN data

There is a lag between a designation and BIN databases or scheme data catching up. The emergency route exists to cover that window.



Ownership isn't on the list

A bank can be sanctioned through ownership or control without being named. Finding it takes an ownership assessment, not just a list lookup.

Three things to take away

01

We block it ourselves

The check sits inside our payment flow, before the scheme sees the payment. Partners don't carry our liability.

02

The list is kept current

Weekly updates, a 2-hour Register update for major designations, and fortnightly reconciliation against industry lists.

03

People make the decisions

The Sanctions Team approves every change to the list, including shared-BIN exceptions.

How sanctioned banks are blocked at the point of payment

A preventive, real-time BIN control: card payments and payouts involving a sanctioned issuer are stopped before authorisation, clearing or settlement.

